From: Yardeni QuickTakes <yardeni-research@ghost.io>
Subject: Weekly Roundup - October 25th
Date: 2 hours ago

Weekly Roundup - October 25th

YARDENI QUICKTAKES

Weekly Roundup - October 25th

By Ed Yardeni • 25 Oct 2026

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Thank you for being a valued member of Yardeni QuickTakes. Here's a recap of the insightful articles, webinars, and market analyses you enjoyed this week:

ECONOMIC WEEK AHEAD: October 26-30

The S&P 500 fell 0.5% last week, and the Nasdaq dropped 0.7%, both posting second straight weekly losses. The Nasdaq's …

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US MARKETS CALL: Still Proceeding Cautiously

On September 15, we advised investors to proceed with caution. We pushed out our 8,400 S&P 500 target from year-end 202…

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AI Credit Crunch?

I. AI Jitters Investors have worried that AI companies are spending too much on data centers. These companies' once am…

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Irrational Exuberance In S&P 500 FEMO?

Are analysts' earnings expectations for the S&P 500 irrationally exuberant? So far this year, FEMO (fabulous earnings m…

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WEEKLY WEBCAST: Question For The Fed: Where Is Waldo?

The risks to the Fed’s dual mandate are constantly changing. Its attempt to hit its inflation target is complicated by …

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What Will Warsh Do?

I. The Fed: To Hike or Not To Hike? The Federal Reserve announces its next interest-rate decision on Wednesday, Octobe…

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FOMO's Rollercoaster Versus FEMO's Steady Climb

I. FOMO vs FEMO Forecasting the stock market is easy! Just multiply the P/E (price-to-earnings ratio) by E (earnings p…

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US SECTORS CALL: Tech Wrecked, Health Care & Staples Rally

The S&P 500 fell 2.0% this week, and Information Technology (MW) took the biggest hit. The sector fell 6.4%, the worst …

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ECONOMIC WEEK AHEAD: October 19 - 23

Last week’s inflation reports came in hot. September’s CPI rose 0.6% m/m, lifting headline inflation from 3.4% y/y in A…

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GLOBAL MARKET CALL: Downgrading 'Go Global' To Market Weight

We are downgrading the “Go Global” portfolio strategy from overweight to market weight and raising “Stay Home” (in the …

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ECONOMIC WEEK AHEAD: October 26-30

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ECONOMIC WEEK AHEAD: October 26-30

By Ed Yardeni & Toby Hearst • 24 Oct 2026

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Photo by Monica Sauro / Unsplash

Live Economic Calendar

October 26–30, 2026

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
26 • Chicago Fed Nat'l Activity (Sep) • Dallas Fed Business Survey (Oct)	27 • Case-Shiller HPI (Aug) • Consumer Confidence (Oct) • Durable Goods (Sep) • New Home Sales (Sep) • Richmond Fed Business Survey (Oct)	28 • FOMC Meeting Statement • Mortgage Applications (10/23)	29 • GDP (Q3) • Personal Income (Sep) • Unemployment Claims (10/24)	30 • Chicago PMI (Oct) • Employment Cost Index (Q3)

yardeni.com/economiccalendar

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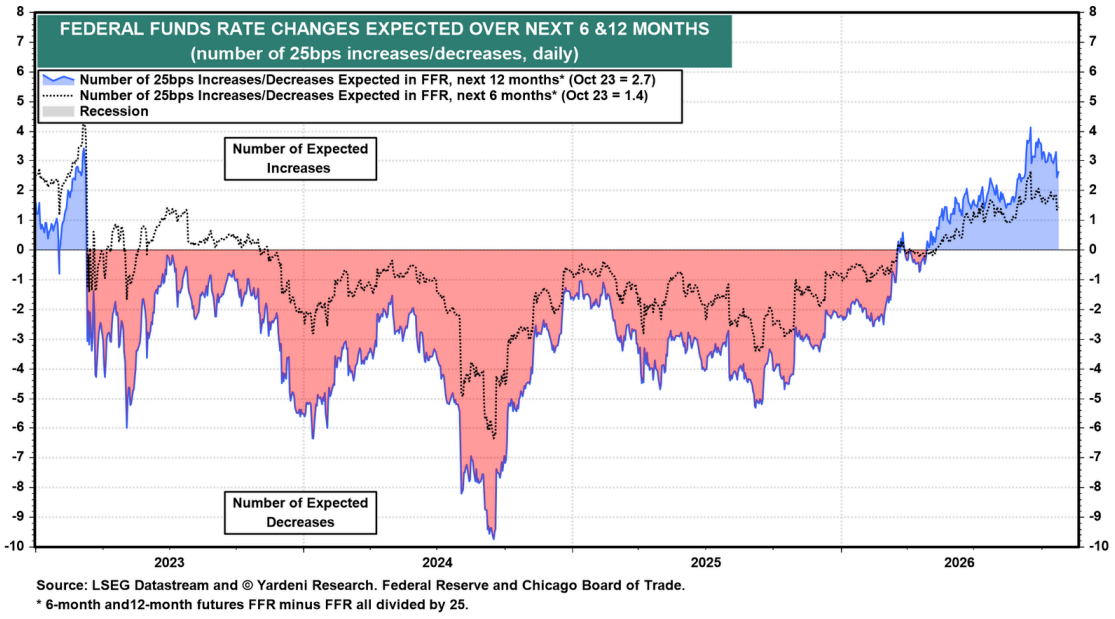
The S&P 500 fell 0.5% last week, and the Nasdaq dropped 0.7%, both posting second straight weekly losses. The Nasdaq's 2.9% slide on Thursday was its biggest one-day drop since June, as concerns flared over the cost and availability of financial capital for AI investment. The price of WTI crude topped $100 a barrel amid US-Iran conflict concerns, while the 10-year Treasury yield fell to 5.0%.

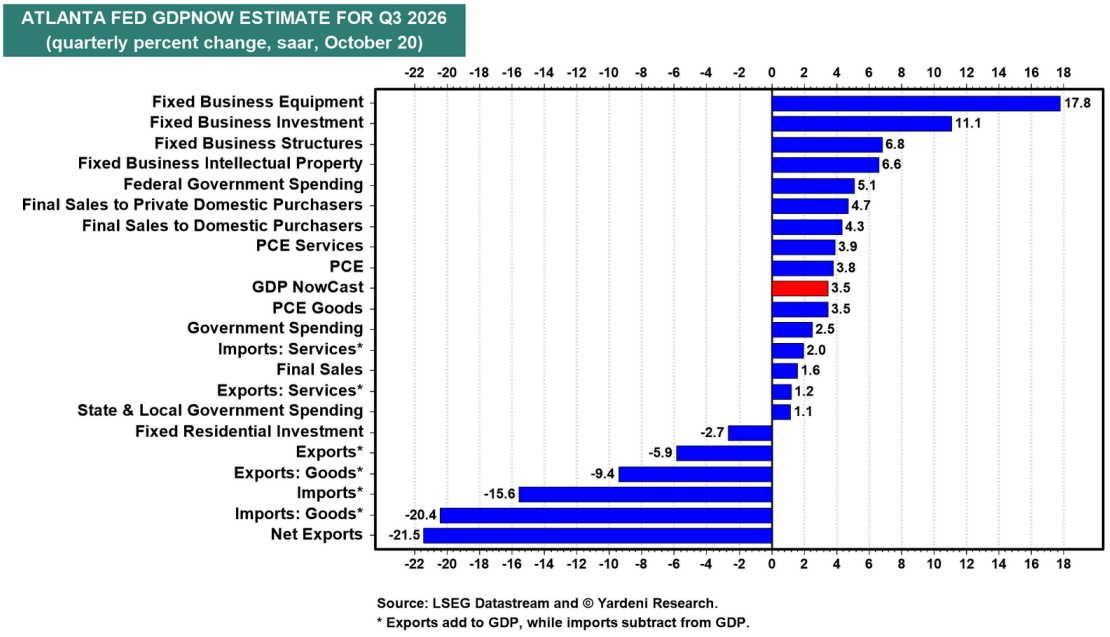
The FOMC meeting (Wed) is the focus this week, alongside the release of Q3 GDP and September's PCED inflation report (Thu). San Francisco Fed President Mary Daly and St. Louis Fed President Alberto Musalem speak on Friday. A heavy week of Q3 earnings reports rounds out a packed calendar. Here's more:

(1) FOMC. The FOMC's two-day meeting concludes Wednesday, followed by Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's press conference. The CME FedWatch Tool puts the odds of a hike this week at 9% and the odds of one in December at 84%. Federal funds futures imply 2.7 rate hikes over the next 12 months and 1.4 over the next six (chart). We believe the committee should hike on Wednesday but won't because the midterm elections are so close.

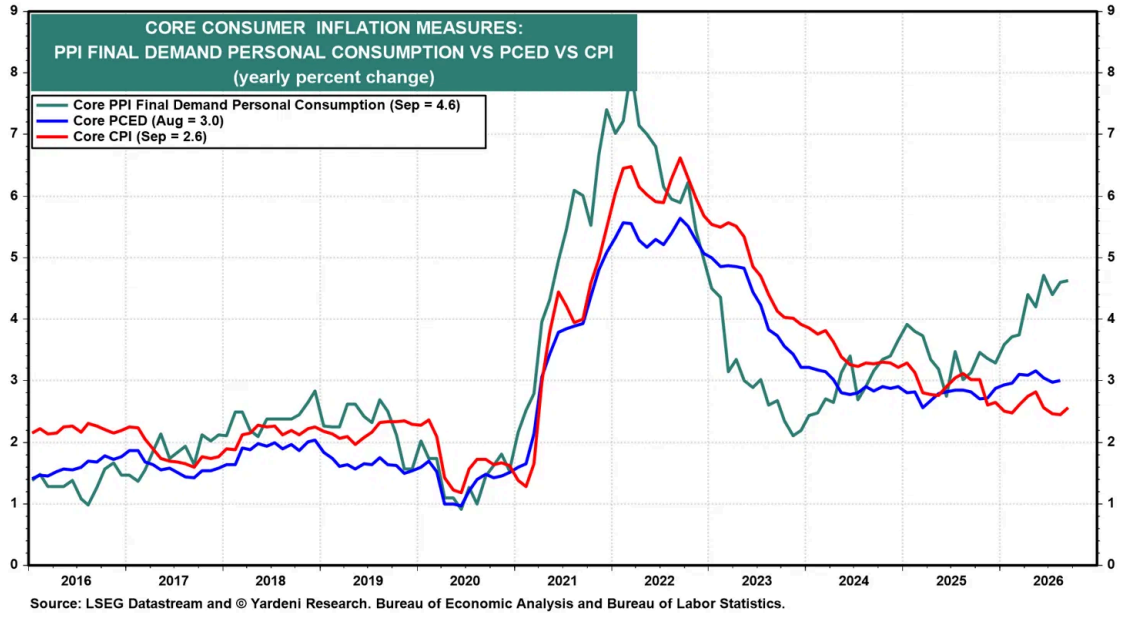


Source: LSEG Datastream and © Yardeni Research. Federal Reserve and Chicago Board of Trade.
* 6-month and12-month futures FFR minus FFR all divided by 25.

(2) GDP & PCED. The first estimate of Q3 GDP (Thu) follows Q2's third estimate of 2.2% saar, with the GDP price index up 6.1%. The Atlanta Fed's GDPNow model estimates Q3 growth at 3.5% as of October 20, led by a 17.8% jump in business equipment spending (chart).



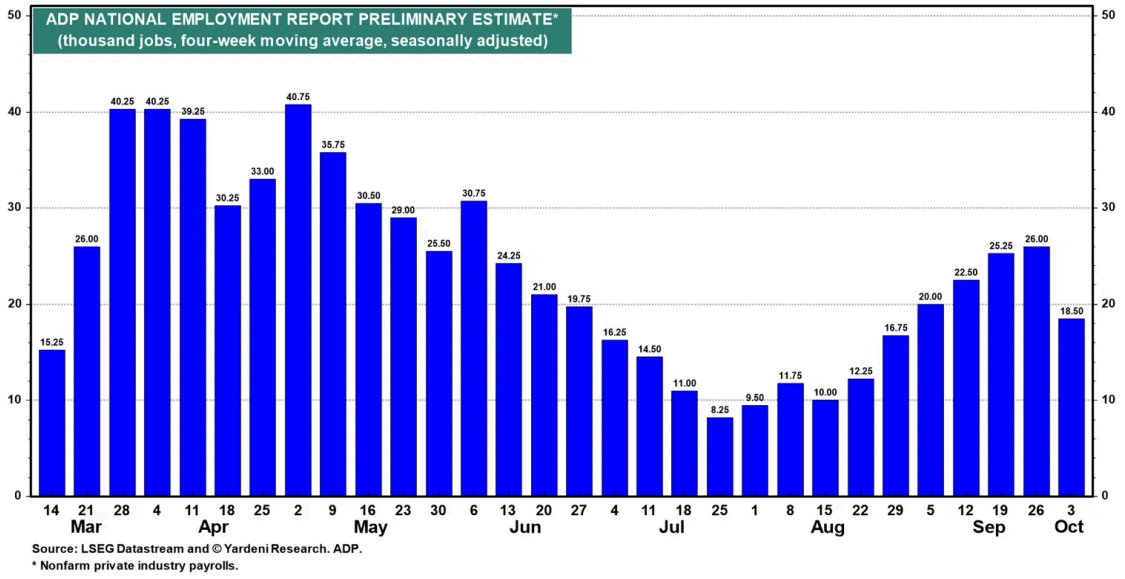
September's core PCED (Thu) follows August's 3.0% y/y. That was well below September's 4.6% pace of core PPI final demand for personal consumption and above the core CPI's 2.6% (chart). The Cleveland Fed's Inflation Nowcasting model projects September's core and headline PCED at 3.1% and 3.6% y/y, up from August's 3.0% and 3.4%. (The model's m/m rates are 0.28% and 0.47%.)



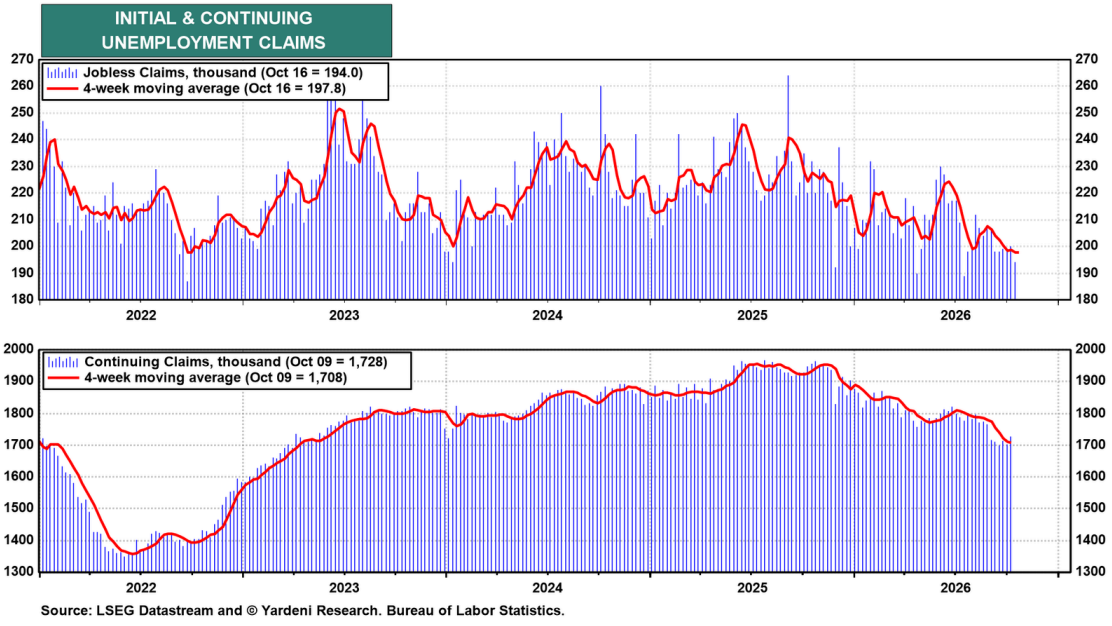
CPI computer software and accessories rose 28.4% y/y in September and PPI electronic components 26.8%, while PCED computers and peripheral

equipment rose just 8.4% in August. September's PCED will show whether that gap starts to close.

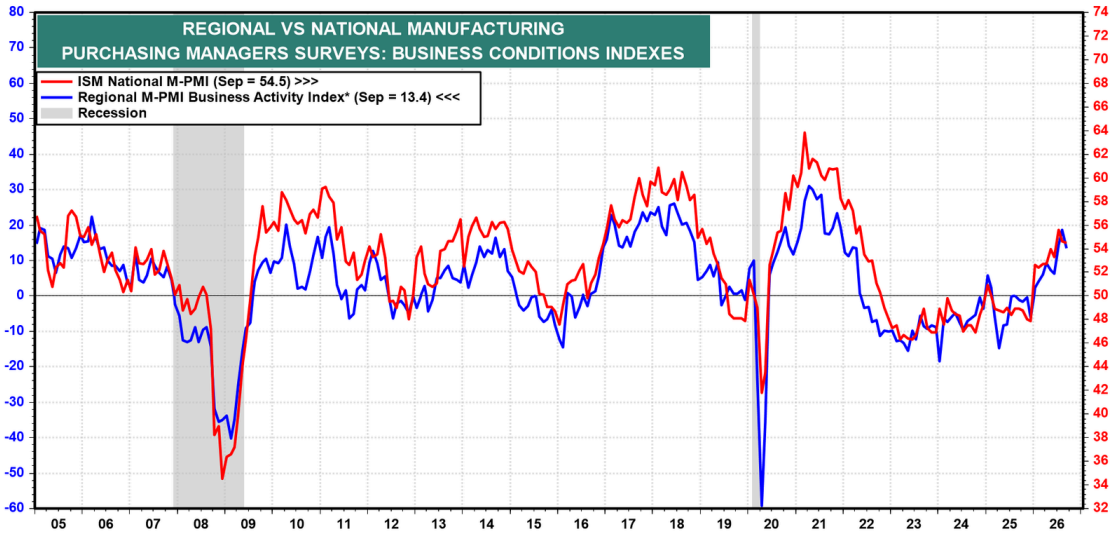
(3) ADP & unemployment claims. ADP's weekly employment reading (Tue) follows a drop in the four-week average to 18,500 for the week ended October 3, down from 26,000 the prior week (chart). That's still more than double July's low of 8,250, pointing to a solid October payrolls report.



Initial jobless claims (Thu) follow last week's 194,000, below expectations and near the lowest level since the late 1960s. The four-week average stands at 197,800 (chart). Continuing claims rose to 1,728,000 for the week ended October 9, up from 1,710,000, while their four-week average edged down to 1,708,000.



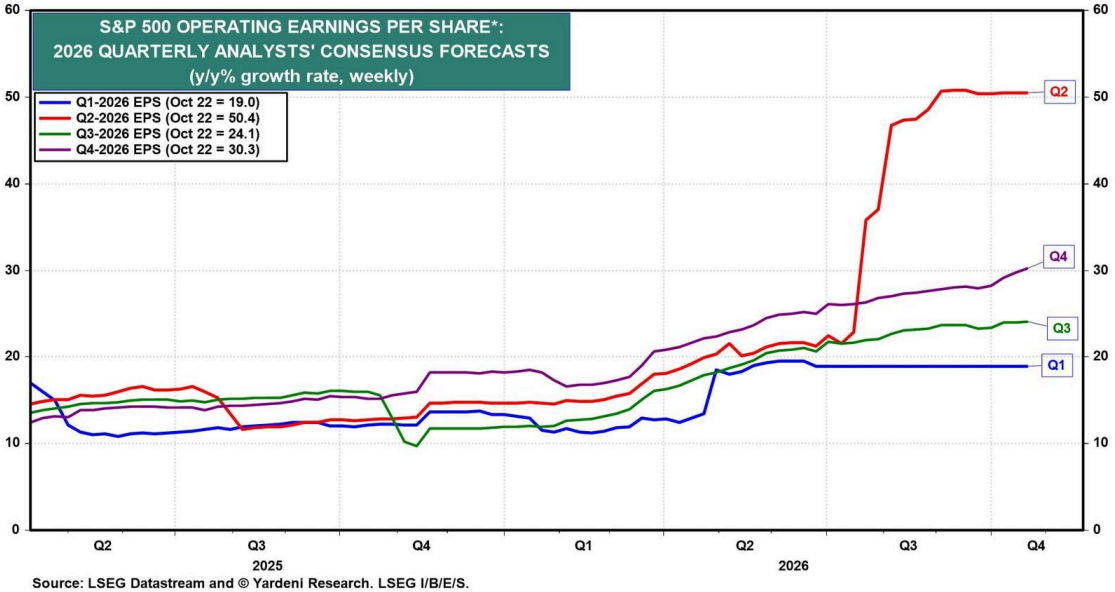
(4) Regional business surveys. The Richmond Fed's manufacturing index (Tue) follows September's -2 reading. The regional M-PMI business activity index slipped to 13.4 in September from August's 18.7, while the national M-PMI eased to 54.5 from 54.6 (chart).



Source: LSEG Datastream and © Yardeni Research. Institute for Supply Management (ISM) and Federal Reserve banks of New York, Philadelphia, Kansas City, Dallas and Richmond.
* Average of Dallas, Philadelphia, Kansas City, New York, and Richmond Fed business surveys.

(5) Earnings. The earnings reporting season heats up this week, with 36% of the S&P 500 companies set to report. Boeing, Seagate, and Corning report on Tuesday. Alphabet, Microsoft, SK Hynix, and GE Vernova follow on Wednesday. Samsung, Intel, Eli Lilly, SanDisk, and Amazon report on Thursday. Exxon Mobil reports on Friday.

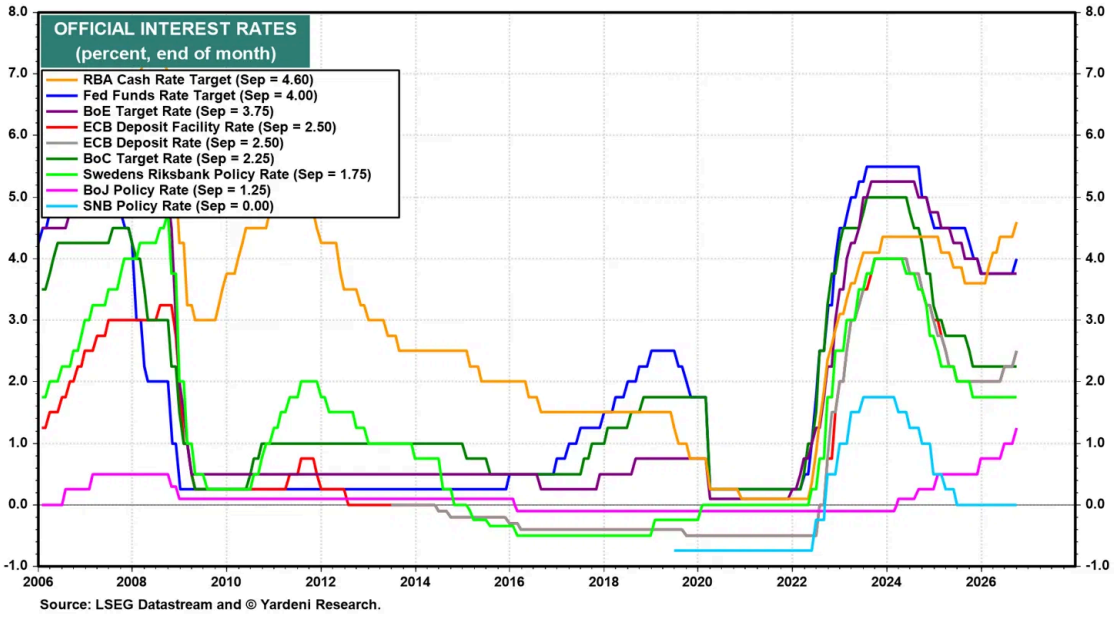
Analysts' consensus estimates imply Q3-2026 operating EPS growth for S&P 500 companies of 24.1% y/y, slightly up from last week (chart). Q4 estimates have also risen.



Source: LSEG Datastream and © Yardeni Research. LSEG I/B/E/S.
* Growth rates compare current members of the S&P 500 with members in the index a year earlier (apples-to-oranges comparisons).

(6) Global central banks. Both the Reserve Bank of New Zealand and the Bank of Canada (Wed) are expected to hike by 25bps. The markets are pricing in 88% odds that the RBNZ will lift its official cash rate to 3.00**%** and an 85% chance that the BOC will raise its policy rate to 2.50%. The European Central Bank (Thu) and the Bank of Japan (Fri) are set to hold their policy rates at 2.50% and 1.25%, respectively (chart).

December is the focus for the latter pair. The markets are pricing in 75% odds of an ECB hike in December and a 74% probability of a BOJ hike. Guidance from ECB President Christine Lagarde and BOJ Governor Kazuo Ueda will show whether those odds hold.



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Andrew Lu on global Semi/Techs 10/17 曾分享費半指數差6.2%破7月份的最低點10445.4，今天收盤後剩下不到3%，更多半導體公司早已經破7月份低點，如果跌破沒支撐，短期真的就很難看，值得觀察的是從7月份超級財報週開始，公司只要公布符合預期或小幅高於預期的財報及營收獲利指引，都是以利多出盡下跌📉處理，即使超市場預期，也頂多來個一日行情，看起來10月超級財報週開始，歷史又重演一次，拉回幅度不遑多讓，7月份同樣的問題又浮出檯面，這到底是1. 基本面無虞，短期估值修正拉回；2. 還是AI擴張舞會即將結束，聰明錢跑路提前反應；你們覺得呢？ 我目前選 1，費半若跌破10000會持續定時定額，但會持續根據數據來關注AI舞會是否結束： 1. 每GW AI數據中心算力租用價格是否反轉下跌？目前是逐步上升； 2. AI數據中心算力租用 Backlog 積壓訂單增幅是否明顯減速； 3. Nvidia 如何處理親兒子 CoreWeave 的財務槓桿問題，是在旁看戲，還是積極參與無折價增資？目前還在看戲中，但肯定在運作增資 4. 財務結構差的Neocloud 是否能繼續擴產，還是被大雲併購而下市？目前還在繼續擴

產 5. Capital return on sales/profits 我們的專用指標是否惡化？目前持續改善中 6. 當AI數據算力中心資本開支增長趨緩後，這些公司的營收及獲利前景是否才開始爆發？目前資本開支動能還是遠遠高於營收/獲利增長動能。 最後就是我們認為要判斷半導體超級週期是否結束，要看他們的下游大客戶怎麼說/怎麼做，而不是看半導體產業鏈怎麼說/怎麼做。

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US MARKETS CALL: Still Proceeding Cautiously

YARDENI QUICKTAKES

US MARKETS CALL: Still Proceeding Cautiously

By Ed Yardeni & Toby Hearst • 24 Oct 2026

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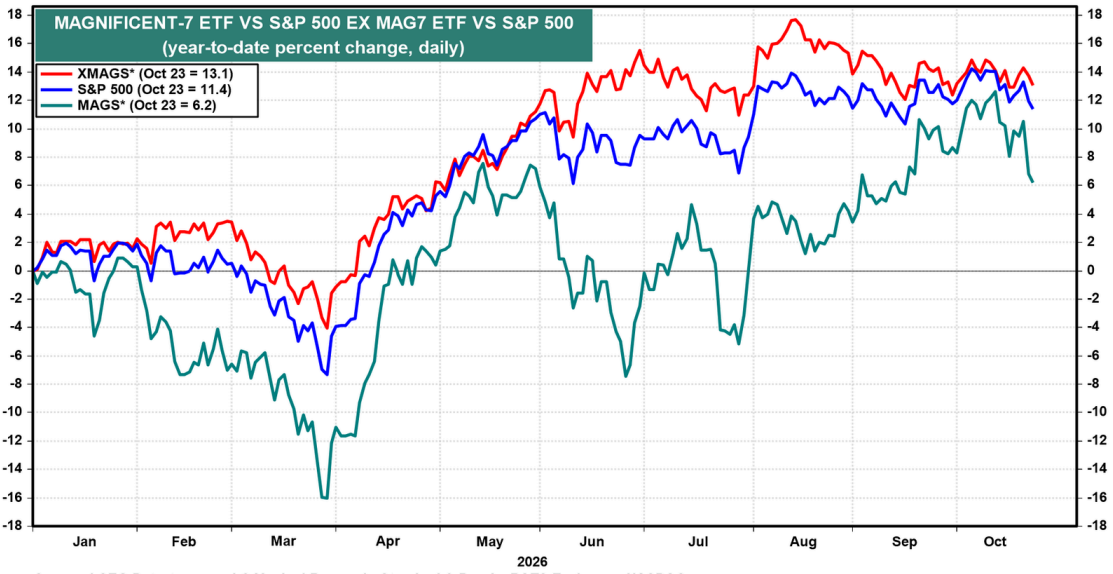
Photo by Jordan Christian / Unsplash

On September 15, we advised investors to proceed with caution. We pushed out our 8,400 S&P 500 target from year-end 2026 to mid-2027 and set 7,900 as our new year-end target. On October 14, we reiterated our caution. Sure enough, the stock market has been turbulent since mid-September, with AI-related stocks falling sharply.

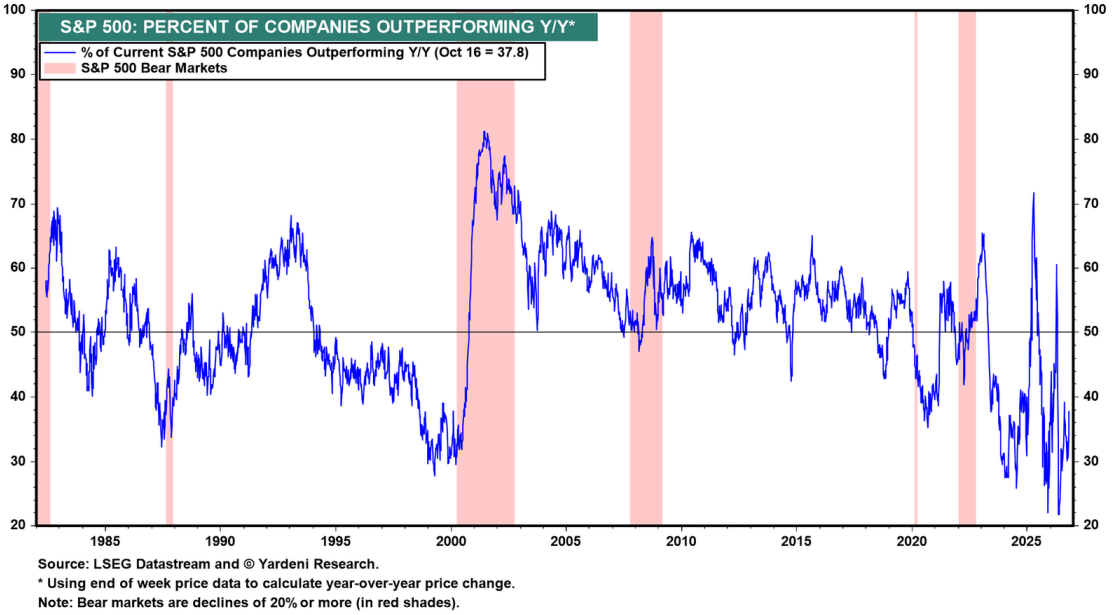
We are seeing some buying opportunities, but better ones are likely after the November 3 midterm elections. Our main concern is a likely escalation of the Middle East war. That could push oil prices above their $120 peak earlier this year.

I. Stock Market Performance

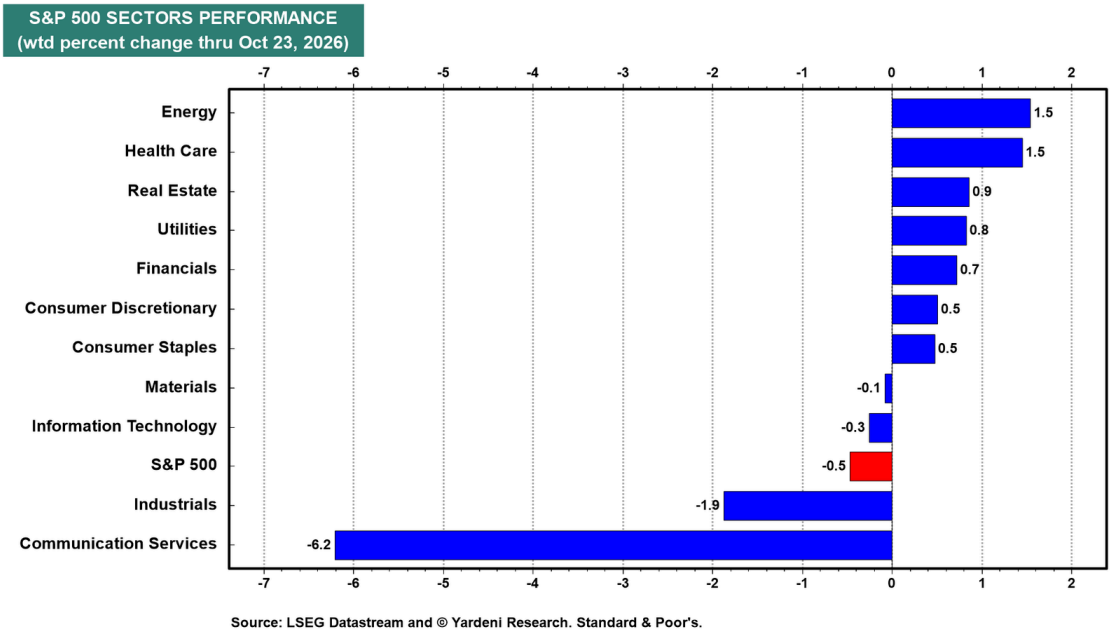
The S&P 500 is still up double digits ytd at 11.4% (chart). XMAGS is up 13.1%, while MAGS is up only 6.2%. The gap has widened again in recent weeks as MAGS rolled over. Meta led the latest leg down, falling 9.4% last week after reporting earnings.



Breadth remained on the weak side. Only 37.8% of S&P 500 companies are outperforming the index on a y/y basis (chart).

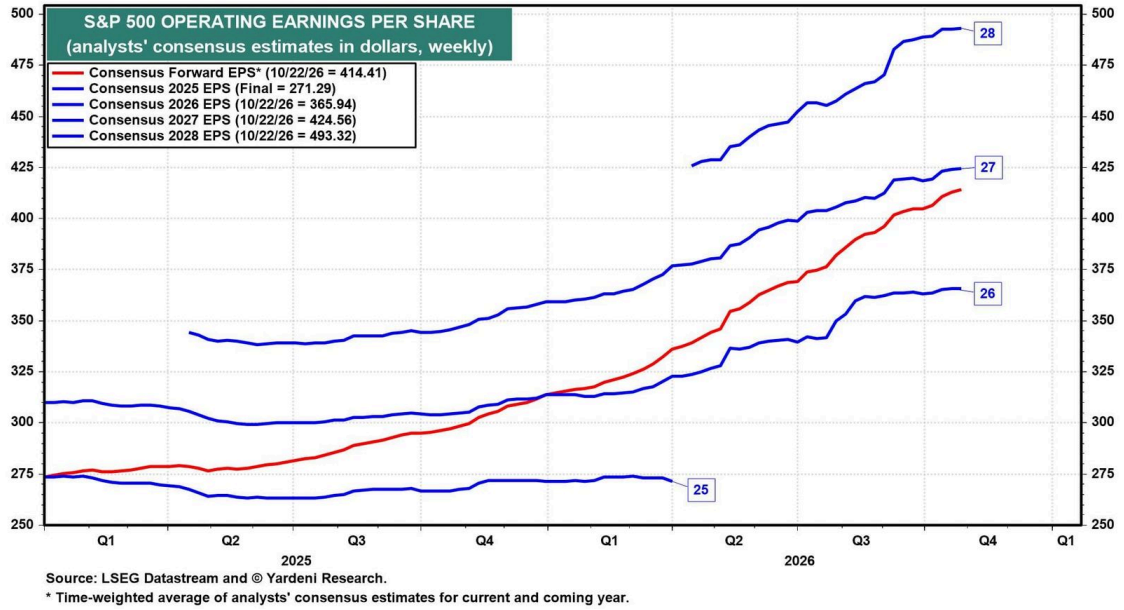


Rotation was notable last week. The S&P 500 Energy and Health Care sectors led with gains of 1.5% each (chart). Communication Services fell 6.2%, and Industrials dropped 1.9%. As bad as the week felt, the S&P 500 was down only 0.5%.



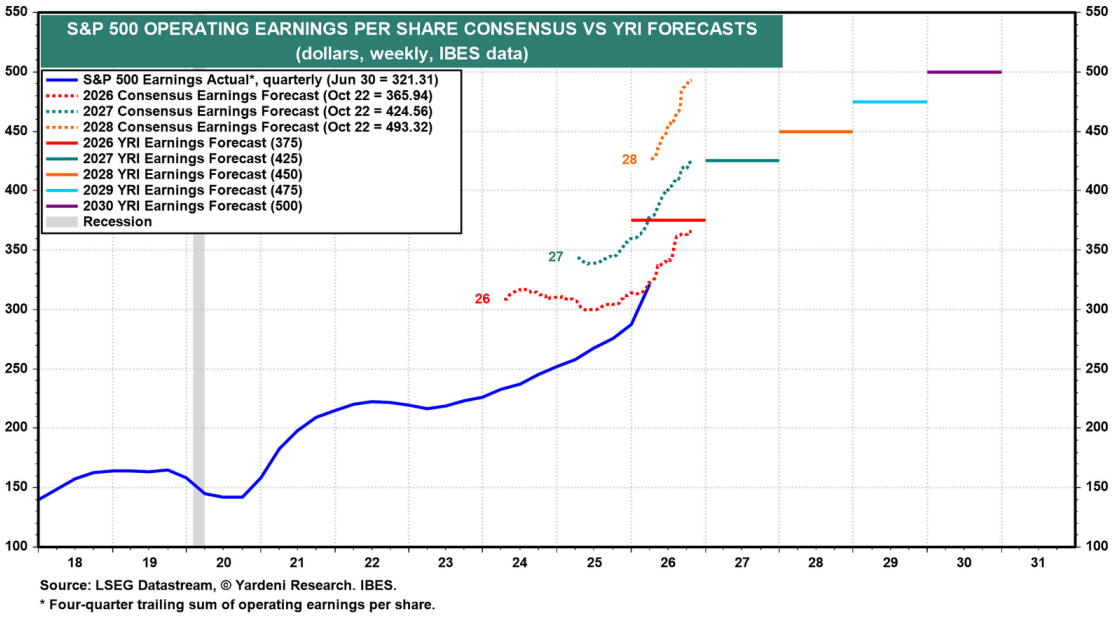
II. S&P 500 Earnings

S&P 500 forward earnings per share rose to a record $414.41 during the week of October 22 (chart). It is converging on the analysts' 2027 consensus estimate of $424.56, up from this year's estimate of $365.94 (chart).

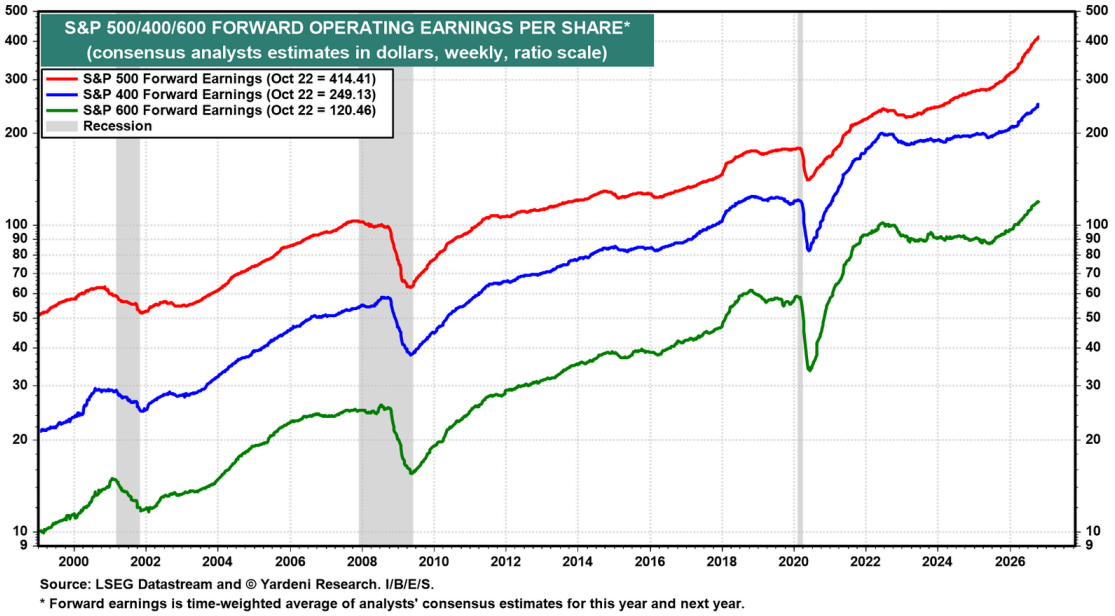


The 2026 consensus is closing in on our $375 per-share forecast (chart). The consensus for 2027 matches our $425 forecast. The 2028 consensus is already $493.32, well above our $450 forecast for that year and almost

at our $500 target for 2030! If the analysts are right, the S&P 500 could rise to 10,000 by the end of next year. We are sticking with that target for the end of 2029. We think the analysts are too bullish on earnings.

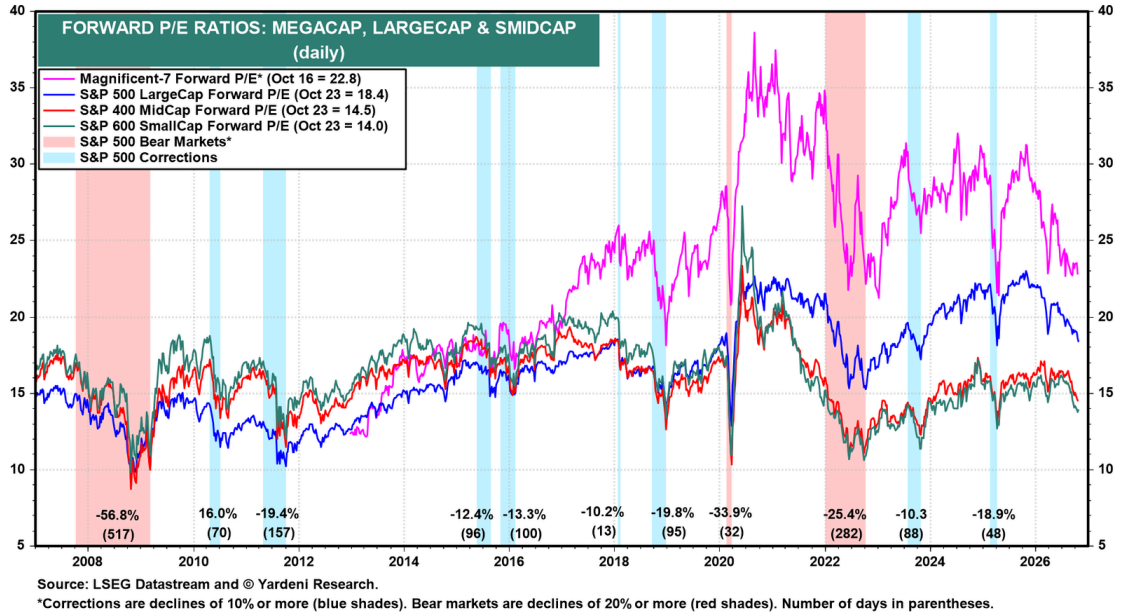


Forward earnings for the S&P 400 and S&P 600 are also at record highs (chart).

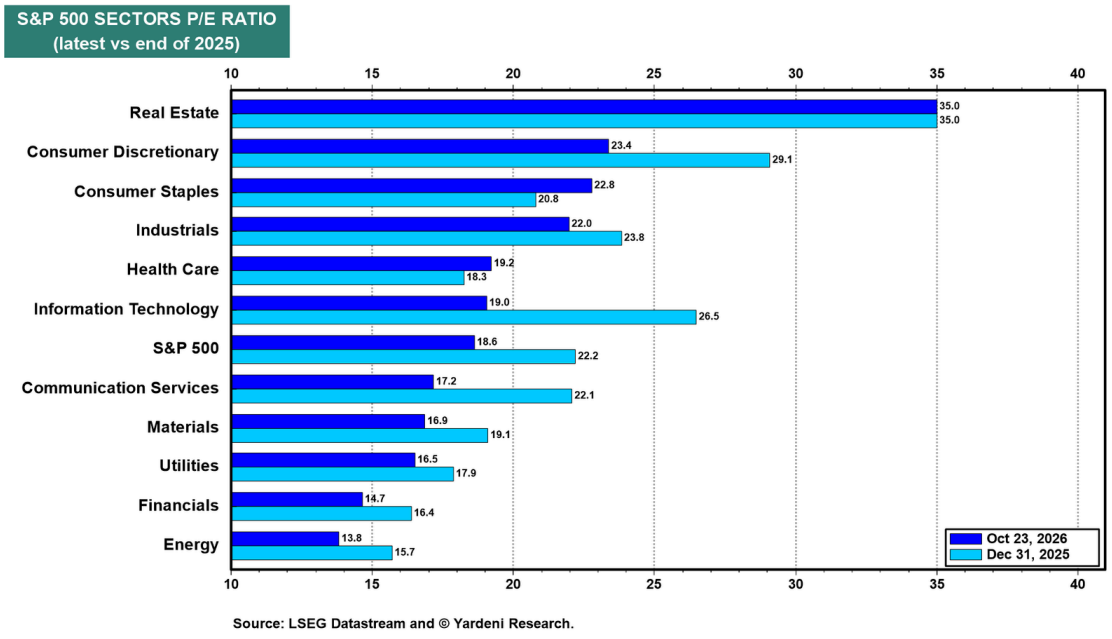


III. Valuation

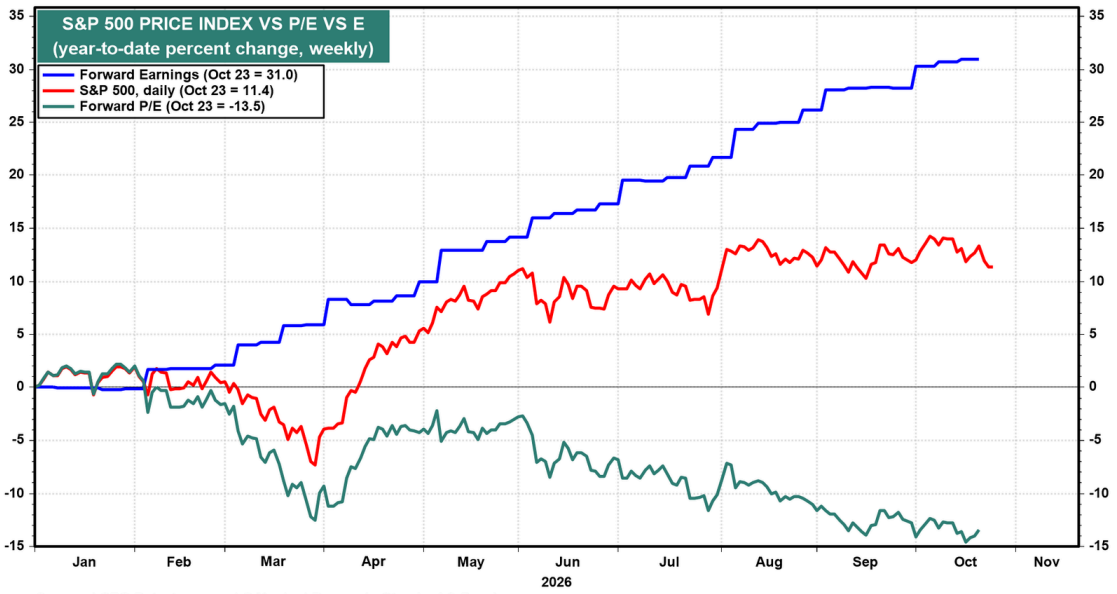
Valuation multiples continue to compress despite strong earnings (chart). The Magnificent-7's forward P/E is 22.8, down from a 2026 peak of 28.5. The S&P 500, S&P 400, and S&P 600 trade at 18.4, 14.5 and 14.0, respectively.



The big valuation story is that for the S&P 500 Information Technology sector. Its forward P/E dropped from 26.5 at the end of 2025 to 19.0 now (chart). The S&P 500 has fallen from 22.2 to 18.6.



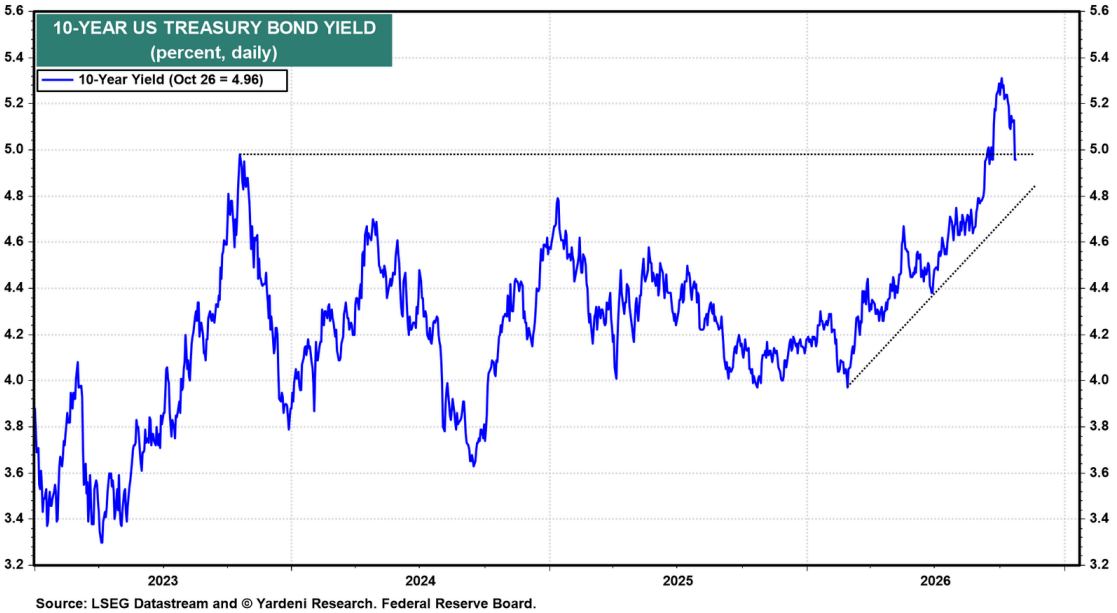
The S&P 500's forward earnings is up 31.0% ytd (chart). The index is up 11.4%. The forward P/E is down 13.5%. Stocks have gotten significantly cheaper this year.



Source: LSEG Datastream and © Yardeni Research. Standard & Poor's.

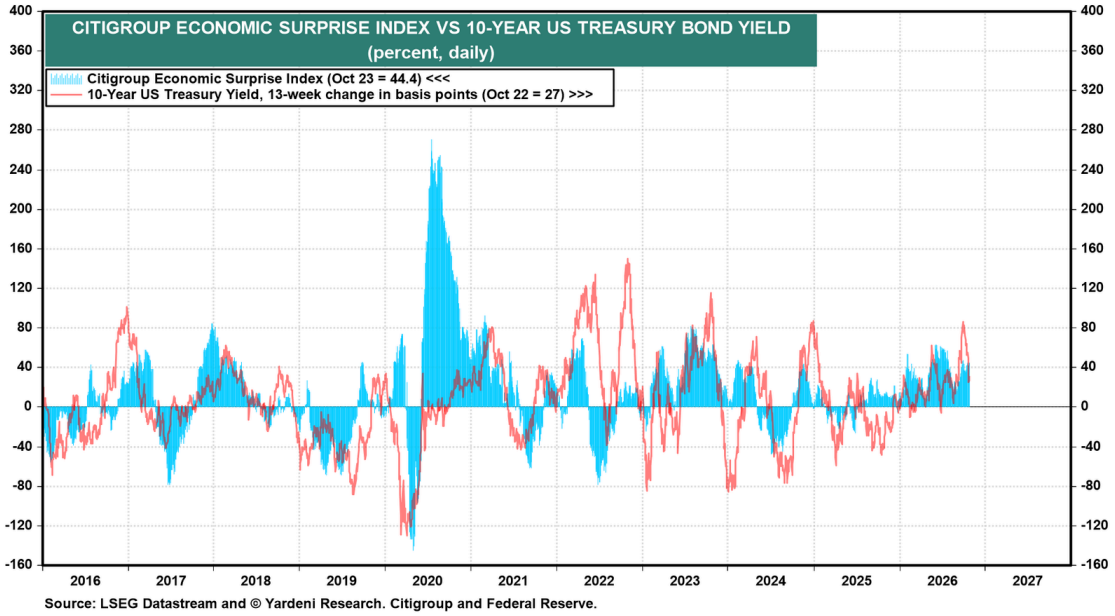
IV. Bonds

The 10-year Treasury yield is back in the “old normal” range of 4.00%-5.00% (chart). It peaked at 5.35%, attracting many buyers. It is now at 4.96%. Some of that decline reflects safe-haven buying during the recent risk-off selloff in the stock market. But market-based measures of long-term inflation expectations remain subdued. Bond investors seem to expect inflation to subside. We agree.

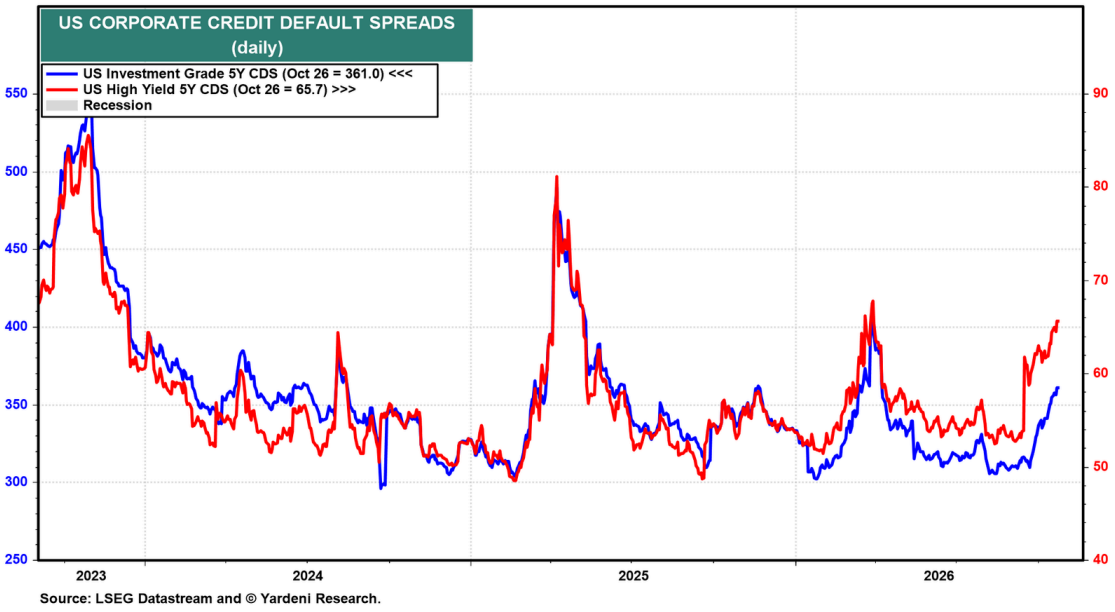


Source: LSEG Datastream and © Yardeni Research. Federal Reserve Board.

The 13-week change in the 10-year yield tends to track the Citigroup Economic Surprise Index (CESI) (chart). Recently, the yield's change overshot the index, as it has done before. Now, the 10-year yield is up 27bps over the past 13 weeks, down from over 80bps a few weeks ago.



Corporate credit default swap spreads are breaking out again (chart). The widening reflects credit-quality concerns about companies like Oracle and CoreWeave. The Bond Vigilantes are regulating credit in the AI ecosystem. That's healthy. We aren't particularly concerned.



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Subject: Nvidia and Tesla jointly invested Korea ABF substrate vendor; Implications
Date: 1 hour ago

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Nvidia and Tesla jointly invested Korea ABF substrate vendor; Implications

Nvidia 與 Tesla 聯手注資三星電機，除了試圖打破 ABF 載板龍頭長期短缺及漲價壟斷，是否也為了採用三星2nm 晶圓代工鋪路?

ANDREW LU ON GLOBAL SEMI/TECHS
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What's new?

2026 年 10 月 22 日至 23 日，路透社（Reuters）、南韓《每日經濟新聞》（Maeil Business Newspaper）與多家科技產業媒體同步披露：全球 AI 晶片霸主輝達（NVIDIA）與電動車及具身智能巨頭特斯拉（Tesla），聯手向南韓三星電機（Samsung Electro-Mechanics）注資約 28 億美元（折合約 3.7 兆韓元），用於其在南韓世宗市（Sejong）工廠大規模新建專用高階覆晶球柵陣列（FC-BGA / ABF Substract）半導體封裝載板產線。此前幾天（10 月 19日），三星電機已於官方聲明中正式確認與全球大型企業達成戰略夥伴協議，將自 2027年1月1日起正式向大客戶供應高階半導體封裝載板（三星电机与全球大型企业签订“存储器半导体用封装基板”长期供应合同（LTA））。報導指出，在 28 億美元注資總承諾中，輝達預計出資約 2.6 兆韓元，特斯拉出資約 1.1 兆韓元。這筆巨額資金旨在為輝達下一代 Blackwell Ultra GB300 NVL72 超級計算叢集、Rubin 架構 GPU，以及特斯拉即將量產的 HW5 自動駕駛車載晶片與 Optimus 機器人神經網絡晶片，鎖定最為緊缺的高層數、大面積先進封裝載板產能。

付費訂閱戶可分享受惠，受害公司/產業，非共識想法，及建議

Subscribed

Positively affect what supply chain vendors and explains why?

三星電機 (Samsung Electro-Mechanics, 009150.KS)：獲得輝達與特斯拉兩大全球最大 AI 算力買家的巨額資本與長約鎖定，使其一舉打破傳統日系（Ibiden, Shinko) 與台系廠商(欣興，南電）的長期壟斷，躍升為全球 AI 載板一線核心主力。

ABF 味之素積層膜材料商（日本味之素 Ajinomoto）與載板設備商：大面積 FC-BGA 載板層數已高達 20 層以上，良率爬坡極耗材料，直接帶動上游特種介電樹脂與雷射鑽孔設備採購放量。

Negatively affect what supply chain vendors and explains why?

傳統載板雙寡頭（日本揖斐電 Ibiden、新光電氣 Shinko）及台系傳統載板廠（欣興、南電）：輝達與特斯拉主動扶持三星電機建立新載板產能，短期可能看不出來，但長期將削弱現有日台供應商過去兩年在高階載板定價上的絕對話語權與超額利潤率，並改變市場份額。以28億美元投資來看，雖然僅佔4%的三星電機市值，但確明顯超過 Ibiden 及欣興近10-15億美元的年度資本開支。

晶圓代工龍頭台積電及封測產業鏈：從Nvidia 及Tesla 在HBM DRAM，DDR DRAM，NAND與三星電子的採購關係，擴大到三星電機 ABF 載板產能擴充的注資，我們不排除 Nvidia及Tesla 將進一步採用三星電子2nm （近期良率有明顯改善）晶圓代工製程及封測技術，讓三星集團進行 AI 訓練及推理晶片製造整合服務來搶台廠份額。

未獲得載板保證的二線 ASIC 晶片設計公司：頂級載板產能被巨頭包攬，使資金鏈較弱的中小 AI 晶片公司面臨載板交期延長至 50 週以上的斷鏈危機。

Our outside the box non-consensus thinking

特斯拉參投載板是「實體 AI 製造去台化/去日化」的戰略預演：市場多將注意力集中於輝達，但特斯拉首次拿出 1.1 兆韓元直投載板廠更具震撼性。這證明馬斯克已深刻意識到——HW5 晶片與百萬台 Optimus 的真正死穴不僅僅是晶圓代工產能短缺，而也包括ABF 封裝載板面積及厚度激增引發的良率瓶頸。特斯拉直接以車企身分下場穿透供應鏈投資底層零組件，正在重構半導體採購範式。

「晶片面積膨脹」倒逼載板成為半導體新護城河：隨著晶片尺寸光罩極限朝 10x 以上突破（Reticle Limit)，單顆 GB300 或 HW5 載板尺寸已超過 100mm x 100mm，相當於一塊小型主機板。載板製造已從傳統 PCB 加工轉變為「類晶圓級微影工程」，載板產能的鎖定甚至比搶奪台積電 CoWoS 配額更具決定性。

Our advises to investors

我們建議投資人關注三星電機（Samsung Electro-Mechanics）及其核心材料設備供應商在產業份額的變化，尤其是在輝達與特斯拉雙重認證下，其高階載板營收佔比將在未來兩年由不足 15% 是否能飆升至 30% 以上，迎來估值重估。適度獲利了結估值處於歷史高點的傳統純載板標的，防範 2027 年三星電機新產能開出後，行業整體毛利率面臨均值回歸的競爭壓力。三星電機產線在大面積 FC-BGA 的翹曲控制（Warpage Control）與熱膨脹良率爬坡仍值得觀察。

Sources of the major news

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